The Mountainside

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CMA Board Meeting Covers CMA Addition, Upgrade, and Financial Issues

The Coolfont Mountainside Association Board meeting was held on December 2 at Marvin Steinberg's house on the mountainside, and covered a wide variety of issues and ideas.

The CMA board and members present discussed the progress of construction for the new addition which adds eight lots off the South Mountainside Road to CMA.

There was much discussion on the width of the road and shoulder areas and the necessity of clear cutting of trees as much as 65 feet from the center line on certain sides. In three areas, the cleared sections measure as wide as 130 feet from tree line to tree line, while the road itself is only 16 feet wide.

The DACC sub-committee on trees was asked to conduct a review of the process of approval and the subsequent cutting, and recommend a response to the developer.

The two CMA representatives to the '95 CDC-CMA Agreement Quality Assurance committee are to be Jackson Bain and Carroll Yingling. Elmer Broxson will serve as consultant to the committee. The two officers are also the point persons for bringing all issues to the attention of CDC. The two areas of concern are environmental and construction/utilities. The on-site observation team will include Alice Minnamon, Don Fox and Dwain Place. They will advise the DACC, the board, and the CDC-CMA Quality Assurance team.

DELINQUENT PAYMENTS PROCESS APPROVED

The two draft letters regarding delinquencies in assessments and water bills, written by Marvin Steinberg, were reviewed and approved at the meeting.

The consideration of hardship cases in the payment of assessments and water bills was discussed with no decision made.

The sense of the meeting was that there should be some consideration for individual hardship cases; but no set policy was developed.

UPGRADE PROGRESS AND DESIGN REVIEW

Preliminary site work is being done on the Phase I area of the new water system, including preparation for road construction to the site of the new, large reservoir that will serve most of the mountainside.

The Phase II upgrade has been reviewed by Jackson Bain and Lee Weinberger who will now get together with John Lewis to review and possibly revise some elements of the Phase II contracts. Any changes will be submitted for review to the PSC and reported to the membership.

NEXT BOARD MEETING:
WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 17
7:00 p.m.
Kensington Library
4201 Knowles Ave.
Kensington, MD

Directions - North on Connecticut Ave. from I-495; 3rd traffic light after 495 intersection turn LEFT on Knowles. One block past first traffic light after turning left on Knowles is the library.

UPGRADE LOAN CHECKS NOT TO BE DEPOSITED UNTIL EARLY 1996

Because of the late start for the upgrade work, it appears that we will not need the money loaned by members for the upgrade until later in the new year.

Consequently, those letters which asked for checks by 1 January and 1 February should now be amended to read 1 March and 1 April.

Those who have already sent in their checks, particularly if they were in the 1 January category have a choice: CMA can hold the check until the new deposit date, or, if you want, CMA can return your checks until we actually need the money. Please let Bob Dowling, Anne-Marie Doppman or Jim Bradfield know your wishes.

POTPOURRI:

SPEEDING VEHICLES NOTED

Also at the board meeting, brief discussions were held on a rising problem of speeding on the mountainside. Several cars and trucks have been observed greatly exceeding the 15 mile-per-hour limit, sometimes recorded at 50 m.p.h.!

The president has written a letter to CRI requesting assistance in reminding CRI guests and employees of the danger of speeding in our neighborhood. All homeowners and their guests are also asked be sure to obey the posted speed limits.

DEER SEASON OVER, BUT STILL BE CAREFUL

Deer season in West Virginia has ended, making our walks through the woods a bit safer. Turkey season extends longer, however, as does bow-and-arrow season. Although no hunting is permitted on CMA property or on the state forest land behind us, there is always the danger of stray bullets from adjoining hunting areas to the north and south, even in the off season. It is always a good idea to wear bright colored clothing when hiking on trails that adjoin CMA or extend into the state forest, just for general visibility and safety.

INFORMATION REQUEST:

As a result of the several questioned water readings during the last quarterly billing, Jim Bradfield requests that those who rent to advise Jim the degree to which you rent and through whom - CRI or independently. Please call or fax him at (301) 984-9657.

WINTER PRECAUTIONS:

Along that same line, we believe it prudent to remind homeowners that Winter in the West Virginia mountains requires some preparation and watchfulness.

To that end, the following comments we included last year in the December newsletter bear repeating:

While it isn't officially winter yet, we have had our two severe freezes so far. It was not evident that any of the unusual water bills for the past quarter were the result of the freezes or damage to pipes. Even so, members should be perform the following cold weather damage prevention actions:

1. Disconnect all outside hoses to non-winterized spigots.

2. If home is infrequently used, turn off the water under the house or in the basement to minimize any potential leaks.

3. If used infrequently, have someone check every few days, or at least once a week, for any sign of a leak around the house and along the water line to the meter itself. For double control, have the valve turned off at the meter.

4. If a leak is evident, call CRI for repairs if you are under the rental program - or call an independent plumber, (e.g., John Hobday- 258-3739 or Dawson's Hardware) for plumbing assistance.

For a house caretaker, there are several local residents who regularly look after CMA properties, such as Raymond Pittman (258-2706).

PARTY TIME? HOW ABOUT SOME CMA SOCIAL EVENT IDEAS?

Tim Black, Recreation and Community Life Committee Chairman, is looking for "a few good ideas" for occasions we can all get together for some fellowship and fun. If you have suggestions, please drop him a line at 8010 Riverside Drive, Cabin John, MD 20854!!